

Do you think people from a particular region are sexually attractive?

YES 22

Male 36, Female 9

NO 76

Male 64, Female 89

Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.

EPICENTRE OF LUST

The geography of sexuality is significant. People from these regions are the most sought-after:

12

India

10

Punjab

8

Jammu & Kashmir

7

America

5

West Bengal

For 1,196 respondents of the total 5,371 who think that people from a particular region are sexually attractive. Figures don't add up to 100 because of multiple choices. All figures in per cent.

18

PER CENT FROM DELHI FIND PEOPLE FROM WEST BENGAL SEXUALLY ATTRACTIVE, WHILE ONLY 10 PER CENT FROM KOLKATA THINK SO.

on Mumbai's streets: don't you have a house and privacy? And the truth is that often they don't. They don't because there are parental restrictions. They don't because their houses are too small and occupied by too many. When public displays of affection are sought to be pushed indoors, it is the morality of the middle classes that is being enforced, the morality that demands a two-bedroom-hall-kitchen flats and closed doors.

The arrival of global sexuality then being celebrated by the media is one that is both deliberately exclusive and claustrophobically narrow. A sexuality that recognises the desires of only a certain class which must only be located in the sanitised spaces of shopping malls, coffee shops, multiplexes, resorts and middle-class model homes. A sexuality that requires perfect, toned, able, deodorised preferably heterosexual bodies, though discreet gay and lesbian bodies of the appropriate class and profession may not be entirely taboo. This celebration then contracts rather than expands both spaces where sexual desire might be expressed and forms in which it might be expressed. It negates the couples in parks and promenades who have no other space in the city. It erases the slum dwellers who must make love under cover of darkness as they share space with others. Most of all it negates people's desires to claim the city as their own in defiance of the arbitrary boundaries of

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